SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #114 · GRACE & WORKS

“Resting or receiving help means I’m spiritually lazy.”

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Where it often comes from

A strong work ethic taught as a measure of godliness. Feeling guilty when you sit still. Pride or embarrassment about needing help. Being the helper in every relationship. Exhaustion or burnout that you push through rather than address.

What Scripture teaches

God designed us for rest. He commanded a Sabbath and promises a rest for His people. Jesus told His tired disciples, “Come with Me privately to a solitary place, and let us rest for a while.” God gives sleep to His beloved. When Elijah was exhausted, an angel fed him and told him to rest, or the journey would be too much. Believers are told to carry one another’s burdens, which means sometimes letting others carry yours. Rest and receiving help are part of trusting God.

> *“And He said to them, ‘Come with Me privately to a solitary place, and let us rest for a while.’ For many people were coming and going, and they did not even have time to eat”* **(Mark 6:31)**.

Also see

> “In vain you rise early and stay up late, toiling for bread to eat— for He gives sleep to His beloved” **(Psalm 127:2)**.

> “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest” **(Matthew 11:28)**.

> “A second time the angel of the LORD returned and touched him, saying, ‘Get up and eat, or the journey will be too much for you.’” **(1 Kings 19:7)**.

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” **(Galatians 6:2)**.

Common self-statements

- Resting is lazy.
- I should be doing more for God.
- I can’t accept help; I should help others.
- If I stop, everything will fall apart.
- Needing help means I’m weak.
- God is disappointed when I take a break.

Common logical errors

- **Should statements:** “I should always be productive.”
- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing you are either working hard or lazy.
- **Pride:** Believing you must never need help.
- **Ignoring limits:** Overlooking that God made you a creature who needs rest.

Challenging questions

- What did Jesus tell His tired disciples to do?

- What does God give His beloved, according to Psalm 127:2?
- How did God care for exhausted Elijah?
- Is resting disobedience or obedience?
- If others should carry burdens, who carries mine?
- What happens when I never rest?
- What would trusting God enough to rest look like?

Truth summary

> Resting or receiving help does not mean I'm spiritually lazy. God designed me for rest, and Jesus invites me to come away and rest. He gives sleep to His beloved. Receiving help is part of the body of Christ carrying one another's burdens. When I rest, I trust that God is in control.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Tired
- Sleep Problems
- Help
- Peace
- Trust

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Resting or receiving help means I'm spiritually lazy"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Resting or receiving help means I'm spiritually lazy." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did Jesus tell His tired disciples?
- ☐ What does God give His beloved?
- ☐ How did God care for Elijah?
- ☐ Is resting disobedience or obedience?
- ☐ If others carry burdens, who carries mine?
- ☐ What happens when I never rest?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God designed me for rest.
- ☐ Jesus invites me to come away and rest.
- ☐ God gives sleep to His beloved.
- ☐ Receiving help is part of the body of Christ.
- ☐ Resting is an act of trust.
- ☐ Jesus gives rest to the weary.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Mark 6:31**
  "And He said to them, 'Come with Me privately to a solitary place, and let us rest for a while.' For many people were coming and going, and they did not even have time to eat."
- [ ] **Psalm 127:2**
  "In vain you rise early and stay up late, toiling for bread to eat— for He gives sleep to His beloved."
- [ ] **Matthew 11:28**
  "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest."
- [ ] **1 Kings 19:7**
  "A second time the angel of the LORD returned and touched him, saying, 'Get up and eat, or the journey will be too much for you.'"
- [ ] **Galatians 6:2**
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Rest log:** Each day, write one way I rested or received help, and thank God for it.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Matthew 11:28 becomes: "Come to Me, **Sarah**, when you are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Tired" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Schedule one block of real rest this week** and keep it like an appointment.
- ☐ **Accept one offer of help** without arguing or apologizing.
- ☐ **Read 1 Kings 19:1–8,** and write how God cared for Elijah's body.
- ☐ **Go to bed thirty minutes earlier for three nights,** and thank God for sleep.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Resting or receiving help means I'm spiritually lazy": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One way I rested or received help
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Resting or receiving help means I'm spiritually lazy.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You for designing me for rest. Help me reject the lie that resting or receiving help means I'm spiritually lazy. Teach me to come away with Jesus and rest, to receive help with gratitude, and to trust that You are in control. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.